of the cordillera descends beneath the sea, forming innumerable islands with steep slopes. The Andes have been deeply carved by glaciers, particularly in the south. Ice masses still occupy some 1900 square miles (4900 square kilometres), constituting a huge ice cap with long terminal tongues running into piedmont lakes or into the sea. The Andes are studded with numerous volcanoes that are part of the Circum- Pacific volcanic chain, often called the Ring of Fire. Earthquakes are frequent.

14. The majority of the forest is contained within Brazil, with 60% of the rainforest, followed by Peru with 13%, Colombia with 10%, and with minor amounts in Venezuela, Ecuador, Bolivia, Guyana, Suriname and French Guiana.
15. Paramaribo, Georgetown, Caracas, Bogota are capitals of Suriname, Guyana, Venezuela, Colombia respectively